

CORPORATE news



Reliance working on four giga factories in Gujarat

Reliance Industries Limited has started work on constructing the Dhirubhai Ambani Green Energy Giga Complex. Located in Jamnagar, Gujarat, the complex will house not one but four giga factories. The four giga factories that Reliance is working on include an integrated solar photovoltaic module factory, an energy storage battery factory, an electrolyser factory, and a fuel-cell factory for converting hydrogen into motive and stationary power.

MediaTek scales up R&D to strengthen presence in India

MediaTek has announced significant hiring plans for FY 2022 as part of the R&D facility expansion and commitment to the India market. MediaTek invested approximately \$2.6 billion (24% of revenues) in R&D in 2020, which is among the top global R&D spend by semiconductor companies. The company plans to hire aggressively from Indian campuses this year.

Exide eyeing to set up lithium-ion battery manufacturing unit

As the need for EV infrastructure in the country becomes more and more clear, battery company Exide Industries has now disclosed its desire to venture into manufacturing lithium-ion batteries. Exide, which is the country's largest lead-acid battery maker, said during the company's AGM that it is still awaiting the guidelines of the production linked incentive scheme for ACC batteries to be notified.

OneWeb and Hughes sign pacts for enterprise services

Bharti-backed OneWeb has signed a distribution agreement with Hughes Network Systems, LLC (Hughes) in the US focused on enterprise services. In India, the companies have entered into a strategic agreement to distribute services to large enterprises, small and medium businesses (SMBs), government, telcos, and ISPs, in the rural and remote parts of the country. Services will be provided by Hughes and Hughes Communications India Private Ltd, respectively.

EV Jagat platform launched to help EV ecosystem in India

EV Jagat, a platform made for all stakeholders in the electric vehicle (EV) ecosystem and powered by government advisory firms and stalwarts from the EV domain, has been launched for the public. Headquartered in Mumbai, with its central warehouse in Navi Mumbai, EV Jagat works with manufacturers of EVs and batteries, and with policymakers and citizens, to establish the right demand for EVs. It claims to work on the perception of potential consumers and drive them towards EVs, using data analytics and artificial intelligence.

Ola's all-women employees' plant plan draws mixed response

Bhavish Aggarwal of Ola recently took to social media to announce that Ola Future Factory will be run entirely by women. The company has already inducted the first batch of women which will be working in the factory. Aggarwal's post on LinkedIn has received mixed response. A lot of the comments on the post have praised the company while some have also asked questions and raised concerns.

Greaves Cotton ventures into EV business

Bullish on the growth of the electric mobility segment in India, engineering group Greaves Cotton has announced its foray into the multi-brand electric vehicle (EV) retail segment. The new venture, AutoEVMart, will serve as a marketplace for all EV prod-

ucts in the country ranging from two- and three-wheelers, and bicycles, along with charging solutions and spares, among others, Greaves Cotton Managing Director and Group CEO Nagesh Basavanhalli said.

OneWeb launches 34 more satellites taking the total to 322

Low-earth orbit (LEO) satcom company OneWeb said it has launched 34 satellites more from the Baikonur Cosmodrome in Kazakhstan, bringing its total in-orbit constellation to 322 satellites. This is nearly half of the entire OneWeb's 648 LEO satellite fleet that will deliver high-speed, low-latency satellite broadband globally. OneWeb has raised \$2.7 billion since November 2020, with no debt issuance.

Reliance closing deal to acquire Europe's largest solar panel maker

With a focus on growing its newly-established clean energy business, Mukesh Ambani-led Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) is looking to buy Europe's largest solar panel manufacturer REC Group. RIL is likely to acquire the company for \$1 to 1.2 billion from China National Chemical Corp (ChemChina). REC produces silicon material for photovoltaic (PV) applications and multi-crystalline wafers. It also makes solar cells and modules.

Minda acquires 26% stake in EV charging startup

Minda Corp and EVQPOINT Solutions have entered into a definitive agreement where the former has announced to acquire 26% equity stake in the latter. EVQPOINT Solutions is a charging solutions startup. The agreement between the two entities is bound to make EVQPOINT an exclusive technology and manufacturing partner of Minda. The agreement spreads across the startup's battery chargers and EV supply equipment.

Nordic Semiconductor setting up global Wi-Fi hub in India

Nordic Semiconductor had announced its acquisition of the entire Wi-Fi development team, core Wi-Fi expertise, and Wi-Fi IP tech assets from Imagination Technologies Group in November last year. It is now well underway creating a global Wi-Fi R&D hub at a former Imagination location in Hyderabad. The hub already has 40 employees and Nordic is looking to grow it rapidly by attracting top R&D talent from within India.

ReNew Power looking to raise \$1 billion from Nasdaq listing

Renewable energy independent power producer (IPP) ReNew Power raised about \$1 billion from its public Nasdaq listing, marking the first instance of an Indian renewable company getting listed in the US market. Proceeds from the IPO will be used to fund its expansion plans, a target of 18.5GW of wind and solar operational capacity by 2025. Currently ReNew has about 6GW of operational capacity and 4.5GW under construction.

Addverb Technologies expands in Europe, Singapore, Australia

Addverb Technologies, a robotics and automation company in India, is further expanding its presence across the markets of Europe, Singapore, and Australia. This strategic initiative stems from increased demand for robotics and automation solutions in the global market. The global robotics market was valued at \$27.73 billion in 2020 and is expected to reach \$74.1 billion by 2026, registering a CAGR of 17.45% during the period of 2021-2026.